



# Using the Globals Page

Version 2026.1  
2026-04-20

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PDF generated on 2026-04-20

InterSystems IRIS Version 2026.1

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# Using the Globals Page

The Management Portal provides tools for viewing, modifying, and working with [globals](#). This topic describes how to use these tools.

For information on defining global mappings, see [Configuring Namespaces](#).

## 1 General Advice

As with the ObjectScript commands **SET**, **MERGE**, **KILL**, and others, the tools described here provide direct access to manipulate globals. If you delete or modify via global access, you bypass all object and SQL integrity checking and there is no undo option. It is therefore important to be very careful when doing these tasks. (Viewing and exporting do not affect the database and are safe activities.)

**CAUTION:** Globals that are part of an extent are managed by corresponding ObjectScript and SQL code. Any changes made to such a global through direct global access may corrupt the structure of the global (rendering its data inaccessible) or otherwise compromise access to its data through ObjectScript or SQL.

To prevent this, you should avoid use the [kill](#) command on globals for tasks like dropping all the data in an extent. Instead, you should use API methods such as `%KillExtent()` or [TRUNCATE TABLE](#), which perform important maintenance, such as resetting associated in-memory counters. However, classes that use a customized storage definition to project data from globals, are fully managed by application code, are exceptions to this rule. In such classes, you should consider setting either [READONLY](#) to 1 or [MANAGEDEXTENT](#) to 0 or both.

When using the tools described in this topic, make sure of the following:

- Be sure that you know which globals InterSystems IRIS® data platform uses. Not all of these are treated as “system” globals — that is, some of them are visible even when you do not select the **System** check box. Some of these globals store code, including your code.

See [Global Variable Names to Avoid](#).

- Be sure that you know which globals your application uses.

Even if your application never performs any direct global access, your application uses globals. Remember that if you create persistent classes, their data and any indexes are stored in globals, whose names are based on the class names (by default). See [Data](#).

## 2 Introduction to the Globals Page

The Management Portal includes the **Globals** page, which allows you to view, and edit globals in different ways. To access this page from the Management Portal home page:

1. Select **System Explorer > Globals**.
2. Select the namespace or database of interest:
  - Select either **Namespaces** or **Databases** from the **Lookin** list.

- Select the desired namespace or database from the displayed list.

Selecting a namespace or database updates the page to display its globals.

3. If you are looking for a particular global and do not initially see its name:

- Optionally specify a search mask. To do so, enter a value into the **Globals** field. If you end the string with an asterisk "\*", the asterisk is treated as a wildcard, and the page displays each global whose name begins with the string before the asterisk.

After entering a value, press **Enter**.

- Optionally select **System items** to include all system globals in the search.
- Optionally select **Show SQL Table Names** to include **Table** and **Usage** columns in the globals table. If a global is used with an SQL table, these columns display the name of that table and its usage, such as whether it is a data/master map or a type of index.
- Optionally select a value from **Page size**, which controls the number of globals to list on any page.

## 3 Viewing Global Data

The **View Global Data** page lists nodes of the given global. In the table, the first column displays the row number, the next column lists the nodes, and the right column shows the values. This page initially shows the first hundred nodes in the global.

To access this page, display the [Globals page](#) and select the **View** link next to the name of a global. Or click the **View** button.

On this page, you can do the following:

- Specify a search mask. To do so, edit the value in **Global Search Mask** as follows:
  - To display a single node, use a complete global reference. For example: `^Sample.PersonD(9)`
  - To display a subtree, use a partial global reference without the right parenthesis. For example: `^%SYS("JOURNAL"`
  - To display all nodes that match a given subscript, include the desired subscript and leave other subscript fields empty. For example: `^IRIS.Msg(,"en")`
  - To display all subtrees that match a given subscript, use a value as in the previous option but also omit the right parenthesis. For example: `^IRIS.Msg(,"en"`
  - To display nodes that match a range of subscripts, use *subscriptvalue1 : subscriptvalue2* in the place of a subscript. For example: `^Sample.PersonD(50:60)`

As with the previous option, if you omit the right parenthesis, the system displays the subtrees.

Then click **Display** or press **Enter**.

- Specify a different number of nodes to display. To do so, enter an integer into **Maximum Rows**.
- Repeat a previous search. To do so, select the search mask in the **Search History** drop-down.
- Select **Allow Edit** to make the data editable; see the [next topic](#).

To close this page, click **Cancel**.

## 4 Editing Globals

**CAUTION:** Before making any edits, be sure that you know which globals InterSystems IRIS uses and which globals your application uses; see [General Advice](#). There is no undo option. A modified global cannot be restored.

The **Edit Global Data** page enables you to edit globals. In the table, the first column displays the row number, the next column lists the nodes, and the right column shows the values (with a blue underline to indicate that the value can be edited). This page initially shows the first hundred nodes in the global.

To access and use this page:

1. Display the [Globals page](#).
2. Select the **Edit** link next to the name of a global.
3. Optionally use the **Global Search Mask** field to refine what is displayed. See [Viewing Global Data](#).
4. Optionally specify a different number of nodes to display. To do so, enter an integer into **Maximum Rows**.
5. If necessary, navigate to the value you want to edit by selecting the subscripts that correspond to it.
6. Select the value that you want to edit.

The page then displays two editable fields:

- The top field contains the full global reference for the node you are editing. For example:  
`^Sample.PersonD("18")`

You can edit this to refer to a different global node. If you do so, your action affects the newly specified global node.

- The bottom field contains the current value of this node. For example:

```
$lb("",43144,$lb("White","Orange"),$lb("8262 Elm Avenue","Islip","RI",57581),"Rogers,Emilio L.",
$lb("7430 Washington Street","Albany","GA",66833),"650-37-4263","")
```

Edit the values as needed.

7. If you make edits, click **Save** to save your changes, or click **Cancel**.

Or, to delete a node:

1. Optionally select **Delete global subnodes during deletion**
2. Click **Delete**.
3. Click **OK** to confirm this action.

Also see [Performing Wholesale Replacements](#).

## 5 Exporting Globals

**CAUTION:** Because of how easy it is to import globals (which is an irreversible change), it is good practice to export only the globals you need to import. Note that if you export all globals, the export includes all the globals that contain code. Be sure that you know which globals InterSystems IRIS uses and which globals your application uses; see [General Advice](#).

The **Export Globals** page enables you to export globals.

To access and use this page:

1. Display the [Globals page](#).
2. Specify the globals to work with. To do so, see steps 2 and 3 in [Introduction to the Globals Page](#).
3. Click the **Export** button.
4. Specify the file into which you wish to export the globals. To do this, either enter a file name (including its absolute or relative pathname) in the **Enter the path and name of the export on server <hostname>** field or click **Browse** and navigate to the file.
5. Select the export file's character set with the **Character set** list.
6. In the page's central box:
  - Choose an **Output format**
  - Choose a **Record format**
7. Select or clear **Check here to run export in the background...**
8. Click **Export**.
9. If the file already exists, click **OK** to overwrite it with a new version.

The export creates a .gof file.

## 6 Importing Globals

**CAUTION:** Before importing any globals, be sure that you know which globals InterSystems IRIS uses and which globals your application uses; see [General Advice](#). There is no undo option. After you import a global into an existing global (thus merging the data), there is no way to restore the global to its previous state.

The **Import Globals** page enables you to import globals. To access and use this page:

1. Display the [Globals page](#).
2. Click the **Import** button.
3. Specify the import file. To do this, either enter a file (including its absolute or relative pathname) in the **Enter the path and name of the import file** field or click **Browse** and navigate to the file.
4. Select the import file's character set with the **Character set** list.
5. Select **Next**.
6. Choose the globals to import using the check boxes in the table.
7. Optionally select **Run import in the background**. If you select this, the task is run in the background.
8. Click **Import**.



## 7 Finding Values in Globals

The **Find Global String** page enables you to find a given string in the subscripts or in the values of selected globals.

To access and use this page:

1. Display the [Globals page](#).
2. Select the globals to work with. To do so, see steps 2 and 3 in [Introduction to the Globals Page](#).
3. Click the **Find** button.
4. For **Find What**, enter the string to search for.
5. Optionally clear **Match Case**. By default, the search is case-sensitive.
6. Click either **Find First** or **Find All**.

The page then displays either the first node or all nodes whose subscripts or values contain the given string, within the selected globals. The table shows the node subscripts on the left and the corresponding values on the right.

7. If you used **Find First**, click **Find Next** to see the next node, as needed.
8. When you are done, click **Close Window**.

### 7.1 Performing Wholesale Replacements

**CAUTION:** Before making any edits, be sure that you know which globals InterSystems IRIS uses and which globals your application uses; see “[General Advice](#).” This option changes the data permanently. It is not recommended for use in production systems.

For development purposes, the **Find Global String** page also provides an option to make wholesale changes to values in global nodes. To use this option:

1. Display the [Globals page](#).
2. Select the globals to work with. To do so, see steps 2 and 3 in [Introduction to the Globals Page](#).
3. Click the **Replace** button.
4. Use this page to find values as described in the [previous section](#).
5. Specify a value for **Replace With**.
6. Click **Replace All**.
7. Click **OK** to confirm this action.

The page then displays a preview of the change.

8. If the results are acceptable, click **Save**.
9. Click **OK** to confirm this action.

## 8 Deleting Globals

**CAUTION:** Before deleting any globals, be sure that you know which globals InterSystems IRIS uses and which globals your application uses; see [General Advice](#). There is no undo option. A deleted global cannot be restored.

The **Delete Globals** page enables you to delete globals. To access and use this page:

1. Display the [Globals page](#).
2. Select the globals to work with. To do so, see steps 2 and 3 in [Introduction to the Globals Page](#).
3. Click the **Delete** button.
4. Click **OK** to confirm this action.

## 9 See Also

- [Introduction to Globals](#)
- [Using the ^%GSIZE Routine](#)
- [Globals \(APIs\)](#)
- [Configuring Namespaces](#) (has information on defining global mappings)